



Unit 3 — Dystopias and Utopias

Track E • Klasse 13 • Niveau E (Basisfach / Leistungsfach) • Abitur year

Learning objectives

- *I can read short utopian extracts (Le Guin, More) alongside dystopian extracts (Atwood) and identify the structural mirror between the genres.*
- *I can use vocabulary of utopia / dystopia (positive utopia, ambiguous utopia, dystopian inversion, eutopia, the imaginary blueprint).*
- *I can write a 450-word essay arguing how utopian writing illuminates dystopian writing.*

Lead-in

The class returns to *The Handmaid's Tale* alongside two utopian extracts: Thomas More's *Utopia* (1516) and Ursula K. Le Guin's *The Dispossessed* (1974). Mr. Yilmaz set the question: *what does Le Guin's subtitle — "An Ambiguous Utopia" — tell us about what utopia is allowed to look like?*

Key points

- *More — Utopia (1516)*: The island of Utopia has no private property and limited working hours; decisions are made by elected magistrates; the regime is humane but homogeneous.
- *Atwood — The Handmaid's Tale*: Gilead's regime speaks the *language of utopia* (purity, order, fertility) while functioning as dystopia. The structural mirror is exact.

Practise

- Match: eutopia → good-place / nowhere; ambiguous utopia → utopia with disclosed costs; dystopian inversion → utopia turned inside out.
- T or F: More's *Utopia* is straightforwardly humane; Le Guin's *Dispossessed* hides its costs; Atwood's Gilead speaks utopia's vocabulary.
- Build 4 sentences applying utopia-dystopia vocabulary to one extract pair.

Your turn

Comparative essay, 450 words. Argue that Le Guin's *ambiguous utopia* clarifies Atwood's Gilead. Use 4 integrated quotes + 7 academic discourse markers + 2 cleft structures.

Reflect

- I can identify the structural mirror between utopia and dystopia.
- I can use 5+ utopia-dystopia terms.
- I can write a 450-word comparative essay.